

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Back to school time!



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe events in the news in a range of social and work contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about school and subjects.
- I can talk about people's past experiences.
- I can talk about habits in the past.

Ask your partner:

- What do you think about the way the school system is set up in your country?
- How do you think schools have changed in the last 75 years?





Let's Explore!

Sally blogs about schools now and then. What **has changed***?

* Remember to use the Present Perfect tense when you want to show a connection to the past and the present.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Seventy-five years ago, most American classrooms looked the same. The students used to sit in straight rows. There was a blackboard at the front of the room with a dais for the teacher. Students listened, recited, read, and wrote. They would show up for class, listen to the teacher and brush up on specific subjects.

During the past 75 years, schools have changed. Educational philosophers developed new ideas about the way people learn, and experimental schools were started. In these special schools, students had a great deal of freedom. Students often signed up for whatever subjects they wanted. Instead of tests, students prepared projects, gave lectures, or conducted research.

We can see the influence of these experimental schools in the modern classroom. Today, most children have more freedom of choice than their parents had. They are encouraged to study subjects that interest them. They write papers about subjects of their choice. Teachers are expected to help students fulfill their individual potential and hand out assignments based on choice. Computers are often used to help learners work at their own level and speed. One thing that hasn't changed, though - the pop quiz!





Let's Practice!

What has *changed*?

Instructions: Underline all the correct answers. Practice saying them aloud with a partner. Switch roles. Check your pronunciation with the instructor.

Which sentences talk about the past with a connection to the present?

- During the past 75 years, schools have changed.
- One thing that hasn't changed, though - the pop quiz!
- Teachers have become less controlling in the classroom.
- Students listened, recited, read and wrote.
- In special schools, students had a great deal of freedom.
- Students have been encouraged to study subjects they are interested in.
- Computers have become an important learning tool.



Let's Practice!

What did students and teachers do?

Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Underline the incorrect word. Rewrite complete the sentence. Use capital letters. Practice reading the sentences aloud with a partner. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. Students showed down to class and listened to the teacher.

2. Udents often signed out for whatever subjects they wanted.

3. Eachers are expected to hand in assignments based on choice.

4. Udents brushed up in specific subjects.





Extension Activity

Research a brief history of schools in your country.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online or visit the library.
- Find some information about school life in your country 75 years ago.
- Take notes and then write a summary of the information you gathered.
- How is school now different from back then? Discuss with your partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I identify facts about what school was like in my country 75 years ago.

☐ ☐

I write a brief summary of the history of schools in my country.

☐ ☐

I discuss the information I found with my partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to show up** (verb): to appear
e.g. Students would show up to class, do the assignments and listen to the teacher.
- to hand out** (verb): to give to many people
e.g. Teachers handed out assignments based on choice.
- pop quiz** (noun): a surprise test
e.g. One thing hasn't changed at schools - the pop quiz.
- to recite** (verb): to say from memory
e.g. Students listened, recited, read and wrote.
- dais** (noun): a raised platform
e.g. The teacher used to stand on a dais at the front of the room.
- blackboard** (noun): a surface that teachers write on with chalk.
e.g. There was a blackboard at the front the classroom.
- to sign up** (verb): to register
e.g. Students often signed up for whatever subjects they wanted.
- to fulfill** (verb): to achieve
e.g. Teachers are expected to help students fulfill their potential.





Learning Points

The Present Perfect Tense vs The Simple Past

You use the Present Perfect tense to talk about an action or event that is connected to the present in some way.

You use the Simple Past tense to talk about a finished action or event **not** connected to the present.

It is common to mix both the Simple Past and Present Perfect when you talk about differences between the past and present.

When you can use the Present Perfect, there is a connection between what happened in the past and now. You use time markers like *for, just, ever, during*, with the Present Perfect.

When you can use the Simple Past, the time is always past. You use time markers connected with the past like: *then, ago, yesterday, when I was ...* with the Simple Past.

Examples:

- *During the past 75 years, schools have changed.*
- *One thing that hasn't changed, though - the pop quiz!*
- *Educational philosophers developed new ideas about the way people learn, and experimental schools were started.*
- *Seventy-five years ago, most American classrooms looked the same.*





Learning Points

Phrasal Verbs

Phrasal Verbs are common in spoken English and casual pieces of writing. There are many phrasal verbs. It is good to think of them like vocabulary. You need to memorize them in order to be able to use them.

There are some grammar rules you use with phrasal verbs.

1. A phrasal verb contains a verb and a participle (a preposition or an adverb).
Some common participles used in phrasal verbs are: *in, out, on, up, into, around, at, off, down, away*.
2. Some phrasal verbs are separable (the object can come between the verb and the participle)
hand out (hand out an assignment, hand an assignment out)
put in (put in some time, put some time in).
3. Some phrasal verbs are inseparable (the object can only come after the participle).
brush up on
show up
sign up

